CITY OF OAKWOOD
STATE OF OHIO
MAY 4, 2026

The Council of the City of Oakwood, State of Ohio, met in a work session at 6:30 p.m. in the conference room of the City of Oakwood, 30 Park Avenue, Oakwood, Ohio 45419. Council then met in a regular session at 7:30 p.m. in the council chambers of the City of Oakwood.

The meeting was streamed live on the Oakwood city website and broadcast on Cable Access Channel 6.

The Mayor, Mr. William Duncan, presided, and the Clerk, Ms. Lori Stacel, recorded. Mayor Duncan asked all present to participate in the Pledge of Allegiance.

Upon call of the roll, the following members of Council responded to their names:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....PRESENT
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....PRESENT
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....PRESENT
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....PRESENT
MR. SAM DORF.....PRESENT

Officers of the City present were the following:

Mrs. Katie Smiddy, City Manager
Mr. Robert F. Jacques, City Attorney
Mr. Douglas Spitler, Public Works Director
Mr. Chris Kuzma, City Engineer/Assistant Public Works Director
Mrs. Sarah Valentin, Building Commissioner
Captain Chuck Balaj, Public Safety Captain
Ms. Lori Stacel, Clerk of Council

The following visitors registered:

Al Aspacher, Fishbeck
Brad Siefker, Fishbeck
Nancy Kravitz, 905 E. Schantz Avenue
Jerad Barnett, Russell Total Wealth and Wellness
Samantha McCoy, Russell Total Wealth and Wellness
Marietta Orlowski, 205 Pointe Oakwood Way
Garrett Orlowski, 205 Pointe Oakwood Way
Paul Bohannon, 204 Pointe Oakwood Way
Hamed Zolbanin, 225 Pointe Oakwood Way
Beth Byington, 24 W. Schantz Avenue
Christine Jefferis, 648 Woods Road
Andrew Hackworth, 440 Peach Orchard Avenue
Hamed Zolbanin, 225 Pointe Oakwood Way
Brian Barr, *Oakwood Register*

Mr. Dorf advised Council he had read the meeting minutes of the April 6, 2026, regular session and work session, and the April 20, 2026 work session. Mr. Dorf reported that he found the minutes to be correct and complete. Therefore, it was moved by Mr. Dorf and seconded by Mrs. Turben that the minutes of the sessions of Council aforementioned be approved as written and the reading thereof at this session be dispensed with. Upon a viva voce vote on the question of the motion, same passed unanimously, and it was so ordered.

STATUS REPORTS

Fishbeck Water System Review – Mayor Duncan noted that the City of Oakwood operates its own municipal water system and, considering pending Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) regulations, engaged consultants to conduct an assessment of the system. Council previously reviewed this matter during a work session and requested that the findings be presented to residents.

Public Works Director Doug Spitler introduced the consultants from Fishbeck and provided an overview of Oakwood's water system, noting the goal of evaluating current conditions and developing a long-term plan.

Brad Siefker of Fishbeck presented a high-level overview of the evaluation of the City's water supply and Water Treatment Plant capacity. The evaluation builds upon the firm's 2023 study and includes an analysis of current and projected water demands to identify trends and long-term system needs.

The plan identifies more than 30 recommended projects over a 20-year period, including water main replacements; service line and water meter upgrades; implementation of a lead service line replacement program; general system maintenance; and improvements to aging infrastructure such as wells and elevated storage. The estimated cost for these improvements is approximately $3 million annually over the planning period.

Projected construction costs are estimated at $14.95 million for years 0–5, $19.97 million for years 6–10, $11.78 million for years 11–15, and $13.7 million for years 16–20, for a total of $60.4 million over 20 years. In addition, construction of a new water treatment plant, estimated at $67 million, was identified for further evaluation at a future date.

Mrs. Jackson inquired about the capital improvement projects identified in the report, asking whether all were necessary or if any were optional. Mr. Siefker indicated that while the projects are comprehensive, some may be considered optional based on engineering judgment, with opportunities to increase system capacity, take a more proactive approach, and enhance system resiliency.

Mayor Duncan emphasized the importance of understanding the scope of the proposed improvements, noting that the City has historically maintained lower water rates, which may need to increase to support future capital improvements. He acknowledged that the process would take time and will address both above ground and underground infrastructure and expressed appreciation for the work completed to date.

Committee Appointment – Mayor Duncan presented the appointment of Robert Ballinger to the Budget Review Committee.

It was moved by Mayor Duncan and seconded by Vice Mayor Byington that the appointment be confirmed. Upon a viva vote on the question of the motion, the same passed unanimously, and it was so ordered.

Proclamations – Mayor Duncan read a proclamation recognizing the week of May 11–16, 2026, as "E-Bike Safety Awareness Week." Captain Balaj provided an update on the Oakwood Public Safety Department's efforts to educate the community on e-bike safety, emphasizing education over enforcement. He encouraged riders to wear helmets and acknowledged the challenges associated with the increasing use of e-bikes. Captain Balaj also referenced a nationwide awareness campaign, advising residents to charge e-bikes using factory-approved devices and only while attended. Parents were encouraged to familiarize themselves with the different classes of e-bikes, and residents were reminded that bike officers are available to answer questions.

Mayor Duncan noted two recent incidents involving individuals texting while riding e-bikes and emphasized that such behavior is illegal.

Mayor Duncan also read a proclamation recognizing the month of May as "Codebreaker Month," honoring the remarkable achievements of Joseph Desch and expressing the City's deep gratitude for his contributions.

VISITORS

Nancy Kravitz, 905 E. Schantz Avenue, addressed Council regarding drainage concerns affecting approximately six homes in the 100 block of Thruston Boulevard. She stated that the absence of curbs has contributed to water runoff issues impacting adjacent properties.

Mayor Duncan and Mr. Jacques advised that such improvements may be pursued through a special assessment petition initiated by the affected residents.

LEGISLATION

AN ORDINANCE
BY MRS. JACKSON NO 5035
AN ORDINANCE DETERMINING TO PROCEED WITH THE IMPROVEMENT OF CERTAIN STREETS BETWEEN CERTAIN TERMINI IN THE CITY OF OAKWOOD, OHIO, BY LIGHTING THE SAME WITH ELECTRICITY.

A copy of the ordinance, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

This is an annual ordinance that is the second step of the 2027 street lighting program. It is the ordinance that authorizes the city to proceed with the project. It was introduced with a first reading at the April 6 Council meeting.

Thereupon, it was moved by Mrs. Jackson and seconded by Vice Mayor Byington that the ordinance be passed.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF.....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said ordinance was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

AN ORDINANCE
BY MRS. JACKSON NO 5036
AN ORDINANCE LEVYING SPECIAL ASSESSMENTS FOR THE IMPROVEMENT OF CERTAIN STREETS BETWEEN CERTAIN TERMINI IN THE CITY OF OAKWOOD, OHIO, BY LIGHTING THE SAME WITH ELECTRICITY.

A copy of the ordinance, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Mrs. Jackson explained that this is the third and final step of the 2027 street lighting program. It allows for the costs of street lighting to be certified to the Montgomery County Auditor for assessment.

Thereupon, it was moved by Mrs. Jackson and seconded by Mrs. Turben that the ordinance be passed.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF.....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said ordinance was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

AN ORDINANCE
BY MR. DORF NO 5037
AN ORDINANCE DETERMINING TO PROCEED WITH THE REPAIRING OF SIDEWALKS AND APPURTENANCES THERETO ON CERTAIN STREETS BETWEEN CERTAIN TERMINI IN THE CITY OF OAKWOOD, OHIO, KNOWN AS ZONES 2 AND 3, AND PROVIDING THAT ABUTTING PROPERTY OWNERS REPAIR THE SAME.

A copy of the ordinance, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Mr. Dorf explained that this is an annual ordinance that is the second step of the 2026 Sidewalk, Curb and Driveway Apron Project. Again, this year's program area covers zones 2 and 3, which include all City streets within the area bounded by Greenmount Boulevard to the north; Monteray Avenue to the south; and between, but not including, Shroyer Road to the east and Far Hills Avenue to the west.

Thereupon, it was moved by Mr. Dorf and seconded by Vice Mayor Byington that the ordinance be passed.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON.....YEA

MRS. LEIGH TURBEN .....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF .....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said ordinance was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

A RESOLUTION
BY VICE MAYOR BYINGTON NO 1948
A RESOLUTION BY THE COUNCIL OF THE CITY OF OAKWOOD, OHIO, DECLARING THE NECESSITY OF A RENEWAL LEVY IN EXCESS OF THE TEN-MILL LIMITATION AND REQUESTING THE COUNTY AUDITOR TO CERTIFY THE TOTAL CURRENT TAX VALUATION OF THE CITY OF OAKWOOD AND THE DOLLAR AMOUNT OF REVENUE THAT WOULD BE GENERATED BY A SPECIFIC NUMBER OF MILLS.

A copy of the resolution, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Vice Mayor Byington explained that this is a resolution to begin the process of renewing the City's 2.72 mill property tax levy. It is an updated version of the same resolution that Council adopted at the April 6 meeting, with a formatting amendment requested by the Montgomery County Auditor.

As noted last month, this is a renewal, and not a new levy. It will maintain the current level of property taxation and will not increase property taxes.

Thereupon, it was moved by Vice Mayor Byington and seconded by Mrs. Turben that the resolution be passed.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON .....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN .....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF .....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said resolution was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

AN ORDINANCE
BY VICE MAYOR BYINGTON NO 5038
AN ORDINANCE ADOPTING THE 2027 TAX BUDGET FOR THE CITY OF OAKWOOD, OHIO, FOR THE FISCAL YEAR BEGINNING JANUARY 2027.

A copy of the ordinance, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title.

Vice Mayor Byington explained that to comply with Section 6.01 of the City Charter, this is the annual housekeeping ordinance to estimate the city's revenues and expenses for calendar year 2027.

The City Charter requires a public hearing on the ordinance, although Montgomery County no longer imposes this requirement.

The public hearing was opened. As no comments were received, the hearing was closed.

Thereupon, it was moved by Vice Mayor Byington and seconded by Mr. Dorf that the second reading be waived and that the ordinance be passed tonight.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MR. STEVEN BYINGTON .....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN .....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF .....YEA

There being five (5) yea votes and no (0) nay votes thereon, said ordinance was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

A RESOLUTION
BY MRS. JACKSON NO 1949
A RESOLUTION TO GRANT APPROVAL OF AN AMENDMENT TO THE APPROVED MASTER PLAN FOR THE SUGAR CAMP AND POINTE OAKWOOD DEVELOPMENT, AFFECTING THE SITE LOCATED AT 1 RUSSELL PLACE.

A copy of the resolution, having been placed on the desks of each member of Council prior to introduction, was read by title. Prior to the reading, Vice Mayor Byington recused himself as he resides near Russell Total Wealth and Wellness. Mayor Duncan accepted his recusal. Vice Mayor Byington then left the dais and was seated in the audience.

Mrs. Jackson explained that this resolution would amend the Sugar Camp/Pointe Oakwood Master Plan to allow for the construction of a pickleball court and expansion of the parking lot at the Russell Total Wealth & Wellness building located at 1 Russell Place.

The Planning Commission conducted a public hearing on this plan amendment on April 1, 2026. By a vote of 4-0, with one member recusing himself, the Planning Commission voted to recommend approval, with certain conditions. These conditions are as follows:

1. The hours of operation would be limited to 9 a.m. to 5 p.m.;
2. Players must utilize sound-dampening paddles and balls;
3. Use would be restricted to Russell Total Wealth & Wellness employees, clients, and prospective clients; and
4. Construction is not to commence until all required permits are obtained.

The matter is now before Council on that recommendation, and tonight Council will hold a public hearing on the application.

This resolution is being introduced to approve based on the recommendation of the Planning Commission. However, Council is required to hold a public hearing on this proposal and has not prejudged the matter. At the conclusion of the hearing, Council may vote to approve the application in its entirety, approve it with conditions, or deny it altogether. If Council decides to approve, as recommended by the Planning Commission, Council will adopt this resolution as-is. If Council decides to adopt the recommendation with modifications or additional conditions imposed by Council, there is space provided on the document to write them in tonight. If Council denies the application altogether or otherwise departs from the Planning Commission's recommendation, Council will withdraw this resolution as written and ask the Law Director to prepare legislation consistent with Council's decision, to be adopted at the next regular meeting in June.

Thereupon, it was moved by Mrs. Jackson and seconded by Mr. Dorf that the resolution be approved.

Public Hearing. Mayor Duncan introduced the public hearing for Application 26-2. He explained the public hearing process and asked Mr. Jacques to administer an oath to those who wish to testify.

Mr. Jacques proceeded to swear in, *en masse*, the visitors who plan to testify.

Mayor Duncan then asked Mrs. Valentin to present the staff report.

Mrs. Valentin reported that Application 26-2 was submitted by Jerad Barnett on behalf of Russell Total Wealth and Wellness to amend the existing Sugar Camp/Pointe Oakwood Master Plan. The request includes the installation of a pickleball court and the expansion of the existing parking lot at 1 Russell Place.

Mrs. Valentin then reviewed the history of the application, noting that a prior application was considered twice by the Planning Commission and Council in 2024. The prior application involved a court location to the south of the Russell office building. The Planning Commission initially recommended it for approval, but it was denied by Council due to notice concerns and returned to the Planning Commission for re-hearing. The result was a second recommendation for approval. However, Council denied it again due to concerns about noise and water drainage. The new proposal, which relocates the court to the west side of the building near the parking lot, was

reviewed by the Planning Commission on April 1, 2026, resulting in a unanimous recommendation for approval subject to conditions.

The proposed pickleball court would be located approximately 180 feet from the public right-of-way along W. Schantz Avenue, approximately 350 feet from adjacent residential properties in Pointe Oakwood, and approximately 240 feet west of the public right-of-way along Sugar Camp Circle. The court is proposed to be approximately 1,800 square feet in size. The parking lot expansion would add 43 spaces, resulting in a total of 70 parking spaces on the site, to accommodate current and future demands.

Mrs. Valentin further noted that both the pickleball court and the expanded parking area would be heavily screened with vegetation to help minimize visual impacts and reduce potential noise for neighboring businesses and residential properties.

Mrs. Valentin then invited Mr. Kuzma to present information regarding drainage.

Mr. Kuzma stated that the Applicant's drainage plan is consistent with requirements of the Stormwater Management Code and was approved on February 9, 2026. He presented supporting maps and indicated that the proposed improvements would not alter existing drainage patterns or increase stormwater runoff.

Mrs. Valentin closed her report by stating that the Planning Commission recommended approval subject to the following conditions:

1. Hours of operation shall be limited to 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m.
2. Sound-dampening paddles and balls shall be utilized.
3. Use of the court shall be restricted to Russell Total Wealth and Wellness employees, existing clients, and prospective clients. The court shall remain locked at all times with controlled access by the owner.
4. The Applicant shall obtain all required permits prior to construction.

Mrs. Turben inquired about the use of sound-dampening paddles. Mrs. Valentin responded that such paddles would be required.

Mr. Dorf asked about enforcement after hours. Mrs. Valentin stated that zoning violations would be issued for noncompliance.

Mrs. Jackson asked whether the plan includes lighting for the court, given the revised operating hours of 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. Mrs. Valentin confirmed that lighting remains included in the plans.

Mayor Duncan asked whether there would be any changes to water flow. Mr. Kuzma responded that there would be no changes and that existing conditions would remain.

Mrs. Turben noted that the original plan had been denied due to noise concerns and asked whether a sound study had been conducted. Mrs. Valentin stated that no study had been completed. Mrs. Turben noted that it would have been beneficial.

Mayor Duncan then opened the public hearing and invited the Applicant to speak.

Jerad Barnett, the Applicant, addressed Council and expressed appreciation for the opportunity to present. He stated that since the initial application to construct the building, the business has doubled in size and that there is a demonstrated need for expansion. He explained that the wellness component of the business has been well received by clients and that the Applicant has been responsive to residents' feedback, incorporating several changes as a result. These modifications include relocating the proposed pickleball court to a more interior location on the campus, increasing the landscape buffer, and incorporating sound-dampening paddles designed to reduce noise levels by up to 50 percent. He further clarified that the facility would not be open to the general public. He added that, with continued business growth, there are long-term plans to explore expansion or the acquisition of an additional building. At present, the primary objectives are the construction of the pickleball court and the expansion of the existing parking lot.

Mrs. Turben clarified whether the proposed noise-reducing paddles would reduce sound levels by 50 percent. Mr. Barnett confirmed that they would.

Mr. Dorf inquired how the proposed pickleball court aligns with the wellness component of the business.

Samantha McCoy, Vice President of Russell Total Wealth, stepped forward to address the question, explaining that the company has made significant investments in employee wellness

following an injury experienced by the owner. She stated that these efforts include the addition of amenities such as a personal trainer, massage therapy, and a hyperbaric chamber, and that the pickleball court is intended to serve as an additional wellness offering.

Mrs. Jackson asked whether there are plans to utilize the lighted courts for purposes other than pickleball.

Ms. McCoy responded that the lighting around the court could be removed if necessary.

Mayor Duncan commented on the proposed 10-foot fence and raised concerns about pickleballs potentially traveling beyond the enclosure.

Mr. Barnett stated that he was uncertain but indicated that, statistically, most balls would be contained within the fenced area. He noted that the 10-foot height is what is recommended by USA Pickleball.

Mr. Jacques administered the oath to an additional speaker, Andrew Hackworth, who had not been sworn in previously. Mr. Hackworth is a resident of 440 Peach Orchard Avenue and works as a Lead Wealth Advisor for Russell Total Wealth & Wellness. He spoke in support of the application and noted that he is an experienced pickleball player himself. He stated that it was highly unlikely pickleballs would travel beyond the proposed 10-foot fence surrounding the court because the game is typically played fairly low.

Marietta Orlowski, 205 Pointe Oakwood Way, spoke in opposition to the request, expressing concerns regarding noise impacts, enforceability of the proposed conditions, and potential effects on neighboring property values. She referenced Special Use Standard D, which requires that a proposed use not be injurious to the reasonable use and enjoyment of nearby properties or substantially diminish property values within the neighborhood, and stated that the proposed conditions would not adequately mitigate or manage those concerns. She further noted that residents did not believe their concerns had been sufficiently addressed and referenced correspondence previously submitted to Council regarding these issues.

Paul Bohannon, 204 Pointe Oakwood Way, expressed concerns regarding vehicle headlights from the proposed parking lot expansion affecting nearby residences, noting that similar concerns had been addressed during earlier site plan revisions. Mrs. Valentin confirmed that the parking area would include extensive landscape screening to mitigate these concerns.

Mr. Byington, 24 W. Schantz Avenue, stated that Russell Total Wealth & Wellness had been a good neighbor and maintained a high-quality development. While expressing support for the parking expansion and the continued success of the business, he raised concerns regarding the proposed pickleball court, particularly related to noise impacts, compatibility with the surrounding residential neighborhood, and the enforceability of the proposed operational restrictions. He further stated that, in his opinion, the proposed use did not align with established community standards or the vision and character reflected in the Oakwood Vision Statement.

Hamed Zolbanin, 225 Pointe Oakwood Way, expressed concerns regarding lighting, privacy, and potential noise impacts associated with the proposal. He also questioned how restrictions on court access and use would be enforced.

Mr. Jacques administered the oath to an additional speaker who wished to address Council.

Christine Jefferis, a resident of 648 Woods Road and an employee of Russell Total Wealth & Wellness, stated that she understood the concerns of nearby residents but believed the court would not create noise impacts beyond those commonly associated with community activities. She emphasized the Applicant's desire to remain a positive member of the community.

Mr. Dorf requested additional information regarding the current wellness operations at Russell Total Wealth & Wellness, including hours of operation and anticipated use of the proposed court.

Ms. McCoy stated that wellness activities generally occur between 9:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m. and anticipated limited use of the court, likely once per day rather than continuously. She further stated that the court would serve as part of the organization's wellness and client engagement program and that quiet-category paddles and balls approved by USA Pickleball would be utilized.

There being no further comments, Mayor Duncan closed the public hearing.

Council discussion followed. Mr. Dorf stated that he had not heard significant concerns regarding the parking expansion but remained focused on how the pickleball court fit within the overall

business plan and the potential impact of noise on nearby residents. He acknowledged that Russell Total Wealth & Wellness had historically been a good neighbor.

Mrs. Jackson reported that she attended the Planning Commission meeting and observed the Commission's efforts to establish reasonable conditions and thoughtful compromises. She also noted that she spoke with several residents who live along W. Schantz Avenue regarding the application. Mrs. Jackson stated that the Applicant has demonstrated a strong commitment to maintaining high standards and responding to neighborhood concerns, and she expressed her support for the Planning Commission's recommendation.

Mrs. Turben stated that she appreciated the Applicant's concessions, including relocating the court further from neighboring residences, but continued to have concerns regarding potential sound impacts. She discussed separation distance recommendations commonly associated with pickleball courts, which she had looked up online, and asked whether a sound study would be appropriate.

Mr. Jacques reminded Council that its decision must be based solely on evidence presented during the public hearing process, and that members may not consider information gathered independently. Discussion followed regarding whether a sound study would provide meaningful additional information, with several Council members indicating they did not believe such a study would alter their positions.

Mayor Duncan noted that the revised court location increased the distance from neighboring residences and reduced potential impacts. He also referenced the Applicant's willingness to eliminate lighting associated with the court and commended the Planning Commission for its unanimous recommendation and proposed conditions.

Discussion continued regarding enforcement of noise complaints and the City's existing processes for addressing nuisance concerns. Council members also discussed the role of the Planning Commission and the weight given to its recommendations.

Mr. Dorf proposed amending the conditions to prohibit lighting associated with the pickleball court. Council was receptive to this additional condition and asked Mr. Jacques for clarification as to how to add it, since approval had already been moved and seconded. Mr. Jacques opined that if Mr. Dorf was proposing an amendment to the motion, it could be accepted by the movant, and Council could then proceed to a vote.

Mrs. Jackson accepted the amendment, with acceptance seconded by Mrs. Turben, to approve Application No. 26-2 with the conditions recommended by the Planning Commission, and with the additional condition that court lighting be removed due to the proposed operating hours of 9:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m. Mr. Jacques was directed to write the additional condition into the ordinance, where space was provided for such additional conditions.

Upon call of the roll on the question of the amended motion, the following vote was recorded:

MR. WILLIAM D. DUNCAN.....YEA
MRS. LEIGH TURBEN.....YEA
MRS. HEALY JACKSON.....YEA
MR. SAM DORF.....YEA

There being four (4) yea votes, said resolution was declared duly passed and it was so ordered.

Vice Mayor Byington returned to the dais.

CITY MANAGER'S COMMENTS

Mrs. Smiddy provided updates on several recent initiatives. She noted that the Communications Survey was launched on May 1 and encouraged all residents to complete it online to help the City better understand community communication preferences and needs. She also shared that she, along with Recreation Supervisor Thomas Hayes and Public Works Director Doug Spitler, attended the Tree City USA award program, where the City was recognized for its 44th year as a Tree City USA community. In addition, she reported that the April 10–11 Perennial Sale was successful, offering a wide variety of plants, and expressed appreciation to staff, the Beautification Committee, and volunteers. Remaining herb plants were donated to Mission of Mary Cooperative in downtown Dayton for use in their garden beds.

COUNCIL COMMENTS

Mr. Dorf thanked Council for its efforts in promoting e-bike safety, noting it as an important step in keeping the community safe. He also extended congratulations to Mike Morgan and Rose Morgan on 30 years at Central Perc.

Mrs. Jackson also recognized Mike Morgan and Rose Morgan on this milestone and commended Alex Heckman, Steve Lucht, and Nancy Chifala for their contributions in bringing the story of Carillon Historical Park to life. She also highlighted a recent e-bike safety class, noting that a bicycle purchased by the City is being used for instructional purposes, and encouraged participation in The Longest Table, a community-wide block party for residents of all ages.

Mrs. Turben expressed appreciation for Council's proactive approach to e-bike safety and its collaboration with the state, noting that Representative Andrea White has been receptive to addressing the issue and may introduce legislation focused on e-bike education.

Vice Mayor Byington noted the upcoming That Day in May is on May 16, one of the City's largest fundraising events, which includes a pancake breakfast, races, and a parade, with former Council Member Rob Stephens serving as grand marshal.

Mayor Duncan reported that on Friday, he and City Manager Katie Smiddy will attend the 19th annual Peace Officers Memorial Ceremony at Riverscape MetroPark, honoring 49 Montgomery County law enforcement officers who have died in the line of duty, including one from Oakwood. On May 15, he will also attend a Sidewalk Soldiers event supporting efforts to rehabilitate women who are victims of human trafficking, as well as a ribbon-cutting ceremony for the Montgomery County Law Enforcement Memorial near the Masonic Temple.

The public meeting concluded at 9:46 p.m.

William D Duncan

MAYOR

ATTEST:

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CLERK OF COUNCIL